

II, although she said her symptoms started when she was 15. Like me, it took her a while to get to the bottom of why she was so impulsive with spending. Fast was interviewed in a 2013 Reuters article, “When Bipolar Disorder Leads to Extreme Shopping.” I found it when I was looking for information on how my disorder affected my spending.

The impulsivity of mania is aided and abetted by shopping apps. People don’t even see the cash in their paycheck before it’s swiped into Ubers and Amazon Prime. In a 2016 *Vice* article, “Your Mental Health Is Making You Poor,” Hazel Sheffield wrote of people with mental illness that “80 percent said they found internet shopping a trigger for spending.”

I definitely needed to cut down on my Amazon spending. (Learn more about this in Chapter 9, “A Fad Diet for Your Wallet.”) The whole “now anyone can indulge any passing whim with the click of a button!” thing hasn’t exactly been ideal for me. I know that I should also delete Postmates, although as a former employee for that company (when I first moved to LA), I do like supporting the People of the Gig Economy. But both Amazon and Postmates make it easy for me to just order what I need when it’d be just as easy, cheaper, and more ethical to pop over to the local grocery store. Without access to online shopping, I can’t just drop \$50 on a new jacket because I feel sad. I’d be forced to find another way to correct my mood.

When you’re feeling crappy, “comfort spending” lifts your spirits, and when you’re flying high, you can experience what’s called “manic spending.” An example of manic spending is when I feel I worked hard at something and therefore deserve new sneakers immediately. Comfort spending is when I’m sad from working too hard and need new sneakers to feel better. Even if you don’t have bipolar disorder, you might be buying material things to fill the emptiness inside.

In her article, Sheffield describes a man who says he was feeling low and flew himself to Paris. (Sound familiar?!)

Here are some things I try to do instead of spending money when I’m sad:

Shower (HUGE! BEST CHOICE!).

Go for a walk or run.